Allocutive agreement and indexicals Shift Together, but not always

Thomas McFadden and Sandhya Sundaresan

1. Introducing allocutive agreement and indexical shift

This paper will examine certain interactions between allocutive agreement (henceforth AllAgr) and indexical shift (henceforth IndShift). Both phenomena target contextual participants in ways that seem to implicate the syntax, thus considering them together should be fruitful. We will see that their interactions in Tamil and other languages involve an interesting constellation of consistency with and violations of the Shift Together constraint. We will argue that this has consequences for theories of IndShift and how Shift Together is implemented.

AllAgr is a phenomenon where clause-level agreement marking reflects properties of the *Addressee* of a context rather than those of an argument of the clause. This is nicely illustrated by the examples from Souletin Basque in (1a)-(1c), reported by Antonov (2015).

(1) a. Etʃe-a banu
house-ALL 1.SG.go
'I am going to the house.'

b. Etʃe-a banu-k
house-ALL 1.SG.go-ALLOC:M
'I am going to the house.' (familiar male addressee)

c. Etʃe-a banu-n
house-ALL 1.SG.go-ALLOC:F
'I am going to the house.' (familiar female addressee)

All three examples express the same propositional content but vary in the morphology on the verb in a way that tracks the properties of the *Addressee*. (1a) shows the neutral form of the verb with 1.SG subject agreement. The others each add an allocutive suffix, restricting each of them to use with *Addressees* with the relevant properties. While the phenomenon does not seem to be especially common, it has now been reported for a growing number of languages showing interesting patterns of variation (see e.g. Bonaparte 1862, Amritavalli 1991, Miyagawa 2010, Antonov 2015, Zu 2015, Bhattacharya 2016, Miyagawa 2017, Alok & Baker 2018, 2022, Kaur 2019, McFadden 2020, Alok 2021, Alok & Haddican 2022). For current purposes, there are three distinguishing properties of AllAgr that will be especially relevant. First, it is clause-level morphosyntactic agreement. Second, this agreement targets the *Adressee*, independent of whether there is a 2nd person argument in the clause. Third, though there is considerable cross-linguistic variation on the details (see Alok & Haddican 2022), AllAgr is primarily found in main clauses. Some languages are reported to block or strongly disprefer embedded allocutivity (e.g. Basque Antonov 2015, though see Alok & Haddican 2022), others allow it in embedded clauses, but only ones that otherwise show embedded main clause behavior (e.g. Japanese and Tamil Miyagawa 2012, McFadden 2020), while still others allow it in embedded clauses more generally (e.g. Magahi, see Alok 2021).

IndShift describes a pattern where indexical elements are interpreted relative to the context set up by an intensional predicate rather than the context of the actual utterance. Indexicals are defined by the fact that their interpretation is essentially a function of a context, set up by an intensional act. When a

* Thomas McFadden, Stony Brook University, thomas.mcfadden@stonybrook.edu. Sandhya Sundaresan, Stony Brook University, sandhya.sundaresan@stonybrook.edu. Thank you to the audience at WCCFL 43 for excellent discussion and helpful comments on the work presented here.

sentence is uttered, we can identy a context for that utterance which includes information about who is speaking, who they are speaking to and when and where this speaking takes place. Indexicals then set up reference to parameters of that context, e.g. *I* to the *Speaker*, *you* to the *Addressee*, *here* to the *Location* and *now* to the *Time*. Now, if an utterance includes a description of an intensional act, e.g. a verb like *say* or *think* that embeds a clause describing what was said or thought, we can identify an additional embedded context defined by that intensional act. Under certain circumstances, an indexical in the scope of such intensional predicates can be interpreted with respect to that embedded context, rather than the context defined by the utterance. Consider the Uyghur example in (2):

(2) Ahmet [$\boxed{\text{men}}$ ket-tim] di-di. (Shklovsky & Sudo 2014)
Ahmet [1SG leave-PST.1SG say-PST.3
'Ahmet$_i$ said that Ahmet$_i$ left.' (literally 'Ahmet$_i$ said that I$_i$ left.')

English *I* is always interpreted relative to the utterance context, so if Stella says "Ahmet said that I left", *I* must refer to Stella. But in the parallel Uyghur example in (2), the 1st person indexical *men* is interpreted against the context defined by the matrix speech verb and thus denotes its agent, Ahmet. Shklovsky & Sudo (2014) demonstrate that the embedded clause in (2) has to be analyzed syntactically as an indirect speech report, thus we cannot explain this pattern away as reducing to quotation. Much like AllAgr, IndShift is cross-linguistically restricted, but it has received increasing attention in recent decades and has now been identified in a significant number of languages. It is also subject to extensive and apparently highly structured variation in the languages where it is found (see e.g. Schlenker 2003, Anand 2006, Sundaresan 2012, 2018, to appear, Shklovsky & Sudo 2014, Deal 2020). For current purposes, we can again identify three especially relevant distinguishing properties of IndShift. First, whereas AllAgr is morphosyntactic agreement, IndShift is a particular kind of interpretation of indexicals. Second, IndShift can involve the full range of contextual parameters, but is arguably centered around the *Speaker*.[1] Third, IndShift *only* appears in environments embedded (at least implicitly) under attitude predicates.

2. When AllAgr & IndShift co-occur

Both AllAgr and IndShift target contextual participants, and both have been argued to involve a syntactic component, indeed to constitute evidence for the representation of speech act participants in syntax. There is thus good reason to study them together. Our expectation should be that the two involve shared underlying mechanisms. In particular, the null hypothesis should be that there is a single syntactic representation of speech act participants and a single set of tools for manipulating and making reference to this representation that both of them make use of. If this is correct, it predicts that they AllAgr and IndShift should show clear implicational interactions. In order to test this, we need to find environments where the two co-occur. Given the distinguishing features of the two patterns noted above, this turns out to be trickier than one might have imagined. First, the fact that both phenomena are relatively rare means that the number of languages that have been reported to exhibit *both* is quite small. Second, and perhaps most importantly, the two are in near complementary distribution with respect to embedding: IndShift is restricted to embedded contexts, while AllAgr, at least in most languages, is primarily a root phenomenon. Third, the fact that AllAgr is a matter of morpho-syntactic agreement, while IndShift is a matter of interpretation, means that any interaction between them is going to be somewhat complicated. What we need to be on the look out for is not interactions between the *possibilities* of the two applying to distinct items in the same environment, but in whether and how they *combine* on a single element. I.e. we're not so much interested in IndShift *plus* AllAgr, but in IndShift *of* AllAgr.

Given these considerations, we can already set aside a number of cases where the two phenomena will trivially fail to interact: languages that lack one or the other entirely, unembedded clause-types where IndShift is impossible, embedded clause-types where AllAgr is impossible, and clauses that have all the right properties but simply lack an indexical of the right kind or don't happen to show AllAgr. Nonetheless, there is enough overlap that the two should be able to interact in those embedded environments where both are licensed. The details will differ cross-linguistically, depending heavily on the conditions under which

[1] For example, while languages vary in which parameters can shift, there are implications among the parameters. If any other parameter shifts, *Speaker* will always shift as well (see e.g. Deal 2020, Sundaresan 2021, to appear).

embedded AllAgr is allowed. Take languages where AllAgr is restricted to (embedded) main clausess. Here we expect interactions between IndShift and AllAgr$_{\text{shifted}}$ in clauses under so-called 'bridge' verbs, which furthermore actually contain a shiftable indexical and AllAgr.

As for the nature of those interactions, the interesting questions revolve around the context against which AllAgr is interpreted. In simple, unembedded clauses, AllAgr reflects properties of the *Addressee* of the utterance itself. But if we embed a clause with AllAgr under an intensional predicate which sets up its own context, will the AllAgr morphology reflect properties of the *Addressee* of the utterance, or that of the speech act defined by the intensional predicate? Magahi, as discussed by Alok & Baker (2018), has rich AllAgr distinctions which make this difference fairly easy to see. Consider the two examples in (3), both to be understood as addressed to a teacher. In (3a), both matrix and embedded clause bear the same high honorific AllAgr, as expected when the *Addressee* is a teacher. In (3b), things are different.

(3) a. Santeeaa Banteeaa-ke kahl-ain ki Ram-ke Sita-se baat kark-e chah-ain.
Santee Bantee-DAT told-HH.AL that Ram-DAT Sita-INS talk do-INF should-HH.AL
'Santee told Bantee that Ram should talk to Sita.' (Alok & Baker 2018: ex. (26), p. 23)

b. Santeeaa Banteeaa-ke kahl-ain ki Ram-ke Sita-se baat kark-e chah-au.
Santee Bantee-DAT told-HH.AL that Ram-DAT Sita-INS talk do-INF should-NH.AL
'Santee told Bantee that Ram should talk to Sita.' (Alok & Baker 2018: ex. (27)a, p. 23)

The matrix verb still bears a high honorific AllAgr marker reflecting the utterance context. However, the embedded verb now bears distinct, non-honorific AllAgr, targetting Bantee, the *Addressee* of the speech act described in the matrix clause, who is a peer of the matrix speaker Santee. We will refer to such AllAgr that targets the intensional *Addressee* as AllAgr$_{\text{shifted}}$. It is this kind of AllAgr$_{\text{shifted}}$ that we should expect to interact with IndShift in the relevant environments in the relevant languages.

Indeed, this expectation is borne out. Examining Tamil, McFadden (2020) shows that monstrous agreement — a pattern analyzed as IndShift by Sundaresan 2012, 2018 — interacts with embedded AllAgr, precisely in the availability of AllAgr$_{\text{shifted}}$. Given the background in (4), Anand may tell Venkat what Maya said to Leela either as in (5) or as in (6):[2]

(4) Maya$_M$ has told Leela$_L$ that she$_M$ is going to win a contest. Anand$_A$ witnessed this and wants to report it to Venkat$_V$, who wasn't there.

(5) Maya$_M$ $\boxed{\text{Leela}_L}$-ʈʈæ [taan$_M$ pooʈʈi-le ʤejkkæ-poo-r-$\boxed{\text{een}_M}$-$\boxed{\text{ŋgæ}_L}$-nnŭ] so-nn-aa.
Maya Leela-LOC [ANAPH contest-LOC win-go-PRS-1S-ALLOC-COMP] say-PST-3SF
'Maya$_M$ told Leela that she$_M$ would win the contest.' (Maya being polite to Leela)

(6) Maya$_M$ Leela$_L$-ʈʈæ [avæ$_M$ pooʈʈi-le ʤejkkæ-poo-r-$\boxed{\text{aaɭ}_M}$-$\boxed{\text{ŋgæ}_V}$-nnŭ] so-nn-aa.
Maya Leela-LOC [she contest-LOC win-go-PRS-3SF-ALLOC-COMP] say-PST-3SF
'Maya told Leela that she would win the contest.' (Anand being polite to Venkat)

In these examples, Anand is the *Speaker* of the utterance context, and Venkat is its *Addressee*. Leela is the *Speaker* of the intensional context associated with the matrix verb *sollŭ* ('say, tell') and Leela its *Addressee*. The question is whether the allocutive marker on the embedded clause targets Leela, which would be AllAgr$_{\text{shifted}}$, or Venkat, which we could refer to as AllAgr$_{\text{unshifted}}$. The answer, it turns out, depends on whether we get monstrous agreement in the embedded clause, i.e. whether we have IndShift. In (5), the embedded clause shows 1st person agreement, but the subject *taan* refers not to the *Speaker* of the utterance context, but to Maya, the *Speaker* of the intenstional context defined by the matrix verb. That is, we have a 1st person form being interpreted against a shifted context, hence IndShift. Here, the AllAgr in the embedded clause *must* be AllAgr$_{\text{shifted}}$. It targets the intensional *Addressee*, Leela, indicating an honorific relationship between Maya and Leela — e.g. Leela could be Maya's boss. In (6), where there is no monstrous agreement, we get AllAgr$_{\text{unshifted}}$ targetting Venkat, indicating an honorific relationship between Anand and Venkat — e.g. Venkat could be Anand's grandfather.

[2] Example (6) is actually ambiguous, since the pronominal embedded subject *avæ* (as distinct from the anaphor *taan* in (5)) can refer to either Maya or Leela in this context. We have only given the indexation for the reading where it is coreferent with *Maya* because that is the intended reading for the minimal contrast with (5). The point is that, even with that coreference, the embedded AllAgr in (6) can only get an unshifted interpretation.

Crucially, this kind of dependency between IndShift and $\text{AllAgr}_{\text{shifted}}$ is not a quirk of Tamil. A strikingly similar pattern has been reported for Magahi. Consider the pair below from Alok (2021):

(7) Santeeaa Banteeaa-ke kahl-ai ki ham toraa dekhli-au/*ain.
Santee.NH Bantee.NH-DAT told-NHS COMP I you-ACC saw.1-NHS.NHA
'Santee$_i$ told Bantee$_j$ that he$_i$ saw him$_j$.' (said to a professor)

(8) Santeeaa Banteeaa-ke kahl-ai ki ham apne-ke dekhli-ain/*au.
Santee.NH Bantee.NH-DAT told-NHS COMP I you.HH-ACC saw.1-NHS.HHA
'Santee$_i$ told Bantee$_j$ that I saw you.' (said to a professor)

Both are to be understood as uttered to a professor, an *Addressee* who would be targeted by high-honorific AllAgr. This is exactly what we find in the embedded clause in (8), but something else is going on in (7). There the embedded clause has non-honorific AllAgr, which can only be appropriate as $\text{AllAgr}_{\text{shifted}}$. It targets *Bantee*, who as the goal of the matrix speech predicate is the *Addressee* of the intensional context, and who stands in a non-honorific relationship with the intensional *Speaker* Santee. Note then that there is an additional difference in the embedded clauses that goes with the $\text{AllAgr}_{\text{shifted}}$. In (7), the indexicals 'I' and 'you' in the embedded clause get shifted interpretations, referring to matrix arguments Santee and Bantee, respectively. The embedded indexicals in (8), on the other hand, get unshifted interpretations, referring to the *Speaker* and *Addressee* of the utterance. Thus again, we see a dependency between $\text{AllAgr}_{\text{shifted}}$ and IndShift within a single embedded environment.

3. Shift Together and theories of IndShift

As argued by Alok (2021) and Alok & Baker (2022), this dependency suggests that $\text{AllAgr}_{\text{shifted}}$ should be understood as a kind of IndShift. That would allow us to susbsume the dependency under the well-known Shift Together constraint:

(9) Shift Together Constraint: "All shiftable indexicals within an attitude-context domain must pick up reference from the same context" (Anand 2006: Ex. 297, 100).

For instance, in Zazaki, all indexicals can optionally shift, leading us a priori to expect four possible interpretations for the utterance in (10) with its two indexicals:

(10) *Scenario:* Ali tells Hasima: (Anand & Nevins 2004: 4, Ex. 13)

Vɨzeri Rojda Bill-ra va kɛ $\boxed{\text{ɛz}}$ $\boxed{\text{to-ra}}$ miradiša
Yesterday Rojda Bill-to said that I you-to angry.be-PRES
LIT. 'Yesterday Rojda said to Bill that I am angry at you.'
READING 1: ✓ Yesterday Rojda said to Bill that I_{Rojda} am angry at you_{Bill}.'
READING 2: ✓ Yesterday Rojda said to Bill that I_{Ali} am angry at $\text{you}_{\text{Hasima}}$.
READING 3: ✗ Yesterday Rojda said to Bill that I_{Ali} am angry at you_{Bill}."
READING 4: ✗ Yesterday Rojda said to Bill that I_{Rojda} am angry at $\text{you}_{\text{Hasima}}$.

However, only two readings are actually attested: either both indexicals shift (Reading 1), or both remain unshifted (Reading 2). Readings 3 and 4, where only one indexical shifts, are unavailable.

Shift Together has broad cross-linguistic support (see e.g. Deal 2020) and thus is generally taken to tell us something important about how IndShift should be modeled theoretically. Specifically, it motivates the 'context-overwriting' class of approaches (see e.g. Anand 2006, Shklovsky & Sudo 2014, Deal 2020). Here, IndShift is implemented by contextual operators (often called 'monsters') which (selectively) overwrite contextual parameters, replacing (parts of) the utterance context with (parts of) the intensional one. All variation and optionality are handled at the operator level. Languages can differ in whether the operator overwrites all contextual parameters or only some (e.g. only the *Speaker*), in which (classes of) intenstional predicates include the operator, and under what circumstances the operator might be optional. Indexicals themselves, however, are universally shifty in principle and are simply interpreted against whatever the local context is, and this is what enforces Shift Together. When a monstrous operator is present, the overwritten parameters of the utterance context simply become inaccessible, and the individual indexicals have no choice but to be interpreted against the shifted context.

4. Shift Together, but not always

Context-overwriting approaches are designed to allow significant, principled variation across languages in how IndShift works, while restricting this in a way that enforces Shift Together. This is very good, because it makes clear predictions about the kinds of variation that should (not) be found. Languages can e.g. vary in which parameters are shiftable — only 1st person, 1st and 2nd etc.[3] — and in which intensional predicates trigger which types of shift. What should not be possible, however, is for there to be variation within a single language in the shiftability of different items that depend on the same contextual parameter. That is, we should not find a language with one shifty 1st person indexical and a distinct non-shifty 1st person indexical. Again, this is because the account of Shift Together depends on making the actual indexicals universally shifty and encoding all variation on the operators.

However, Shift Together exceptions of this kind do seem to exist (see especially Sundaresan 2018, 2021). We will focus here on two specific such exceptions from Tamil because of how they interact with AllAgr. First, in (11) we have a an embedded clause which has monstrous 1st person agreement plus an overt 1st person pronoun as direct object.

(11) SHIFT TOGETHER EXCEPTION – TAMIL MONSTROUS AGREEMENT + 'I':

Raman$_R$ [$_{CP}$	taan$_R$	$\boxed{\text{enn-æ}_{*R/Speaker}}$	paartt-$\boxed{\text{een}_R}$-nnŭ]	ottŭɳɖ-aan.
Raman	ANAPH.NOM	me-ACC	saw-1SG-COMP	admitted.-3MSG

'Raman$_R$ admitted that he$_R$ had seen me$_{Speaker}$'

The agreement is associated with the subject of the embedded clause, the long-distance anaphor *taan*, bound here by the matrix subject *Raman*. Relative to the utterance context, this is thus a 3rd person referent, but relative to the intensional context defined by the matrix verb, *Raman* is the *Speaker*. The 1st person agreement has to be interpreted relative to that intenstional context, hence we have 1st person IndShift. The 1st person object pronoun *enn-æ* in that same embedded clause, however, cannot be interpreted as 1st person relative to the embedded context, i.e. as coreferent with *Raman*.[4] Rather, it can only be interpreted relative to the utterance context, i.e. as referring to the *Speaker* of the entire utterance. We thus have two indexicals within a single attitude-context domain that don't pick up reference from the same context, an apparent violation of Shift Together.

Now, one could note that Shift Together as state in (9) explicitly only applies to 'shiftable' indexicals and propose that what's going on here is that, while monstrous agreement involves a shiftable 1st person indexical, the overt 1st person pronoun in (11) is not shiftable. As it turns out, overt 1st person pronouns in Tamil never undergo IndShift (Sundaresan 2012). The Shift Together constraint itself would then survive examples such as these — and this is indeed what we will end up proposing. Note however that these examples *do* still present a problem for the context-overwriting approach to Shift Together. Again, that depends on indexicals themselves being uniformly shiftable, with variation being down to the monstrous operators. So if a language has 1st person pronouns that never shift — like English e.g. — this should be because the language lacks an operator that shifts 1st person. What this does not countenance is what we see in (11), where two distinct indexicals that target the same contextual parameter differ in shiftability.

This issue is not unknown. There are in fact a number of examples of this kind that have been reported in the literature on other languages, frequently such that overt indexicals don't shift, but covert ones in pro-drop scenarios or agreement morphology do (Sundaresan 2018, Deal 2020, Sundaresan to appear). Deal (2018, 2020) has proposed that what is going on in at least some of these cases is actually not a Shift Together violation at all and can be readily handled under a contextual overwriting approach to IndShift. The idea is that the item that looks like a shifted indexical doesn't actually involve an indexical at all, but rather something she dubs an 'indexiphor'. An indexiphors is a kind of logophor — an anaphoric element that is restricted to refer to an immediately local attitude holder — but with the added grammatical quirk that they trigger 1st person agreement. Since they aren't indexicals, they aren't actually interpreted against

[3] Again, there seem to be implications here among the specific parameters, which can be modeled in a context-overwriting approach in terms of the structures of the various monstrous operators as in Deal (2020).

[4] Note that Tamil does not have distinct anaphoric forms for 1st and 2nd person, so the impossibility of this reading is not simply a Condition B effect.

a context, and that means that they don't diagnose context overwriting. The fact that true indexicals like the overt 1st person pronoun don't get a shifted interpretation is thus as expected.

Now, such an indexiphoric analysis may well be on the right track for certain purported Shift Together violations, and Deal (2020) presents very nice arguments that what is going on in a number of such patterns behaves differently in crucial ways than uncontroversial cases of IndShift. However, the situation in Tamil offers an additional wrinkle that makes things more difficult for an indexiphoric analysis. This pops up when we bring in AllAgr. The fact is that monstrous agreement in Tamil *does* obey Shift Together: as we saw in (5) and (6), monstrous agreement and AllAgr have to Shift Together when they're in the same domain. In fact, this particular pattern is what Alok & Baker (2022) call Shift Together 2, where distinct parameters (here *Speaker* and *Addressee*) must Shift Together. This means that we're not dealing with individual contextual parameters being tweaked and manipulated, but the shifting of an actual non-trivial context as a coherent whole. This makes an indexiphoric analysis for (11) considerably more difficult. Indexiphoric status is a matter for an individual element, which makes sense analytically when one apparent indexical dances out of line from the others. But that is precisely *not* what is going on here. If anything, the one 'indexical' that is out of line (in that it refuses to shift) is the overt 1st person pronoun, the one that we cannot analyze as anything but an indexical. The only way for an indexiphoric analysis to even be possible here would be if we say that both monstrous agreement and AllAgr in Tamil are indexiphoric.[5] While Deal (2020) has argued for the existence of 2nd person indexiphors, it should be noted that what would be needed here would be slightly different. Shifty argument agreement, like Tamil 1st person monstrous agreement, can be and usually is analyzed as agreement with a silent 1st person pro-form in argument position, which could plausibly be an indexiphor (or, of course, a shifted indexical). AllAgr, on the other hand, is not generally thought to be agreement with a silent 2nd person pro-form, because it precisely is not related to any argument in the clause. Rather, it is agreement with the *Addressee* component in the syntactic representation of the speech act. It is far more difficult to imagine that being an indexiphor, if for no other reason than the fact that the representation of the *Addressee* isn't so much 2nd person as it is the referent relative to which 2nd person is defined.

Setting aside the possibility of a logophoric analysis then, this basic pattern of systematic exceptions to Shift Together is actually quite general in the language. We've seen that 1st person argument agreement and AllAgr can be shifted, while overt 1st person pronouns cannot. This extends to overt 2nd person pronouns, which also are unshiftable, and to the combinations of AllAgr$_{\text{shifted}}$ with either 1st or 2nd person overt pronouns, which yield additional systematic Shift Together violations. Examples of these are given, along with an appropriate discourse context, in (12):

(12) Raman$_R$, Maya$_M$, Leela$_L$ and Venkat$_V$ are cousins. Leela and Venkat are aspiring actors who have recently appeared in their first movie roles. Maya has seen one of these movies, and Raman has conveyed this fact to their grandfather$_G$. Leela is now telling this fact to Venkat.

a. SHIFT TOGETHER EXCEPTION – TAMIL ALLAGR$_{\text{SHIFTED}}$+ 'I':

Raman	taattaa-kiṭṭæ	[Maya	$\boxed{\text{enn-æ}_{*R/L}}$	paa-tt-aa-$\boxed{\text{ŋgæ}_G}$-nnŭ]	so-nn-aan.
Raman	Grandpa-LOC	[Maya	me-ACC	see-PST-3SF-ALLOC-COMP]	say-PST-3SM

'Raman told Grandpa that Maya saw me$_L$.'

b. SHIFT TOGETHER EXCEPTION – TAMIL ALLAGR$_{\text{SHIFTED}}$+ 'YOU':

Raman	taattaa-kiṭṭæ	[Maya	$\boxed{\text{onn-æ}_{*G/V}}$	paa-tt-aa-$\boxed{\text{ŋgæ}_G}$-nnŭ]	so-nn-aan.
Raman	Grandpa-LOC	[Maya	you-ACC	see-PST-3SF-ALLOC-COMP]	say-PST-3SM

'Raman told Grandpa that Maya saw you$_V$.'

The conditions on honorificity in Tamil are such that the cousins will all use honorific forms with their grandfather, but non-honorific forms with each other. Now, the utterance *Speaker* here is Leela, and the utterance *Addressee* Venkat, two of the cousins, so the AllAgr we see in the embedded clauses cannot be coming from that speech act. Instead, it must be targetting the grandfather as the *Addressee* of the intensional context. Thus we have AllAgr$_{\text{shifted}}$. Each of the examples also includes an overt indexical pronoun in the embedded clause, 1st person 'me' in (12a) and 2nd person 'you' in (12b). Neither of these

[5] In order to get their Shift Together-like behavior, we would then have to ensure that their logophoric binding is always restricted to participants of a single intensional predicate.

can be interpreted as shifted, i.e. ‘me’ can’t refer to Raman in (12a), nor can ‘you’ refer to grandfather in (12b). Rather, they have straightforward unshifted reference to the utterance speech act participants Leela and Venkat, respectively. With those reference patterns, the two sentences are fully grammatical and acceptable, and thus we have two more Shift Toghether exceptions.

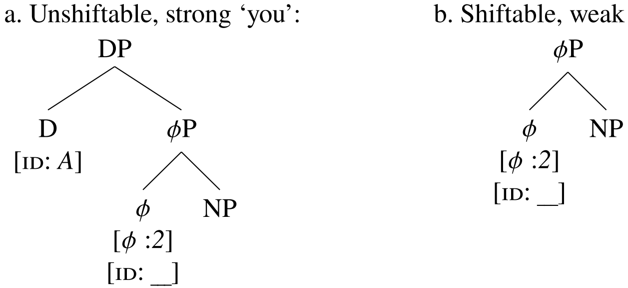
5. Why *these* exceptions?

Of course, the exceptions we have seen here could be taken as evidence of an issue with Shift Together, that it’s a mere tendency rather than a hard constraint reflecting a deep property of IndShift, or that it has a more restricted application and needs to be reformulated. This seems like a mistake. For one thing, as we’ve noted, the constraint does seem quite robust cross-linguistically. For another, and more importantly for present purposes, the apparent exceptions to Shift Togther fit into a consistent pattern that can actually be seen to underscore the validity of the constraint. What the exceptions we’ve discussed here and others discussed by Sundaresan (2018) have in common is the co-occurrence of two distinct classes of indexical, one of which is shiftable in the language, while the other is consistently unshiftable. Again, overt 1st and 2nd person indexicals in Tamil never undergo IndShift, completely independently of the presence of other elements that might shift (Sundaresan 2012). Only the indexical elements involved in monstrous agreement and AllAgr ever shift in the language. The crucial thing to understand is that Shift Together and its apparent exceptions are completely regular and predictable in the language once those facts are taken into account. If two shiftable elements co-occur in a single environment, they do indeed obey Shift Together, as we saw in (5) and (6). If one shiftable element and one non-shiftable element co-occur, and shift happens, we will get an apparent Shift Together exception.

Now, as noted above, if we go back to Shift Together as formulated by Anand (2006) in (9), this kind of pattern doesn’t actually constitute an exception. We simply have to be okay with saying that shiftability is defined (and can vary) not just at the level of contextual parameters and the monstrous operators that can rewrite them, but also at the level of individual indexical items. It’s not enough to simply say whether 1st person can shift in a language. We have to be able to specify that some 1st person forms can shift while others can’t. What this *is* inconsistent with is the context-overwriting approach to IndShift. If the relevant parameters of the utterance context are completely overwritten and thus inaccessible in a shifted environment, there should be no way for any indexical in that environment with one of the shifted parameters to have an unshifted interpretation. I.e. the concept of specific indexicals being unshiftable is incoherent under context overwriting. If we take the patterns discussed here seriously, which do descriptively seem to require this notion of shiftability for individual indexical items, then we must find a different way forward. Whatever its issues, context overwriting was the lynchpin for systematic accounts of Shift Together, and the conclusion we have reached is that Shift Together is indeed real and consistent in a way that we want to be enforced by our theory of IndShift. We cannot develop such a theory in the current paper, but we will make some suggestive remarks about how it might look, with pointers to places where some of the ideas are discussed further.

If we go beyond just the Tamil facts to consider similar patterns of variation in the shiftability of specific pronouns, it is frequently covert pronouns and agreement that shift, while overt pronouns resist shifting (Sundaresan 2018, Deal 2020). In fact, no language seems to shift an overt indexical while its covert counterpart remains unshifted (Sundaresan 2018). Sundaresan (to appear) accounts for this by having unshiftable indexical structures contain the shiftable ones, as in (13):

(13) a. Unshiftable, strong ‘you’: b. Shiftable, weak ‘you’:



Inspired by Cardinaletti & Starke (1999) and Déchaine & Wiltschko (2002), shiftable indexicals are then a sub-type of 'weak' pronouns, expected to be morphologically reduced relative to unshiftable ones.

Now, in order for these structures to derive variable shiftability, while enforcing Shift Together with shiftable indexicals, we need something like the following. Rather than a context-overwriting operator, IndShift involves a monstrous quantifier that binds contextual variables, but leaves the existing utterance context unchanged (see Sundaresan 2018, updating ideas from Schlenker 2003). The shiftability of individual indexicals is determined by whether their contextual variable can be bound externally or not. The extra structure of unshiftable indexicals contains a built-in binder that simply tracks the utterance context, which remains accessible. Shiftable indexicals lack this structure, thus their contextual variable must be bound by the minimal contextual quantifier, which guarantees that two in a single environment will Shift Together. The apparent violations of Shift Together arise when indexicals of these two types co-occur, as in combinations of monstrous agreement or $\text{AllAgr}_{\text{shifted}}$ with overt indexicals.

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